

Lesson 4 Notes: Complete C++ Diagonal Matrix Program

1. Main idea of Lesson 4

Lesson 4 continues the same diagonal matrix idea from Lessons 1, 2, and 3.

We are **not learning a new matrix type yet**.

We are still working with a **diagonal matrix**.

A diagonal matrix stores meaningful values only on the main diagonal.

Example:

```
5 0 0 0
0 8 0 0
0 0 9 0
0 0 0 12
```

The important values are:

```
5, 8, 9, 12
```

So the compact stored array is:

```
A = [5, 8, 9, 12]
```

The diagonal matrix rule is still:

```
if (i == j)
```

That means:

- If `i == j`, the position is on the main diagonal.
- If `i != j`, the position is outside the main diagonal.
- Outside diagonal positions are structural zeros.
- Structural zeros are not stored.

The index formula for diagonal positions is still:

A[i - 1]

Lesson 4 focuses on writing a **complete C++ diagonal matrix class program**.

The main new ideas are:

- Default constructor
- Parameterized constructor
- Destructor
- `Set()` method
- `Get()` method
- `Display()` method
- 1-based matrix positions in `Set()` and `Get()`
- 0-based loops in `Display()`
- Testing the class in `main()`
- Tracing the program output
- Understanding time and space complexity

2. What you already know before Lesson 4

Before Lesson 4, you should already understand these ideas:

Concept	Meaning
Diagonal matrix	A matrix where only the main diagonal values are stored.
Main diagonal	Positions where row number and column number are the same.
Diagonal condition	<code>i == j</code>
Non-diagonal position	A position where <code>i != j</code>
Structural zero	A zero that exists because of the matrix rule, not because it is stored.
Compact array	A 1D array that stores only useful matrix values.
Index formula	For diagonal positions, use <code>A[i - 1]</code> .
Class	A C++ blueprint that stores data and functions together.
Constructor	A special function that runs when an object is created.
Destructor	A special function that runs when an object is destroyed.
Dynamic memory	Memory allocated during program execution using <code>new</code> .

3. Lesson 3 vs Lesson 4

In Lesson 3, we created a C++ class for a diagonal matrix.

The class used:

```
int n;  
int *A;
```

It also had:

```
Diagonal(int n);  
~Diagonal();  
set();  
get();  
display();
```

Lesson 4 makes the program more complete.

The main difference is that Lesson 4 adds a **default constructor**.

So now the class has:

```
Diagonal();           // default constructor  
Diagonal(int n);      // parameterized constructor  
~Diagonal();          // destructor
```

This means we can create a diagonal matrix object in two ways:

```
Diagonal d1;          // uses default constructor  
Diagonal d2(4);       // uses parameterized constructor
```

4. What is a complete C++ diagonal matrix program?

A complete C++ diagonal matrix program should contain:

1. A class named `Diagonal`
2. Private data members
3. Constructors

4. Destructor
5. Methods to set, get, and display values
6. A `main()` function to test the class

The class should be able to:

- Create a diagonal matrix
- Store diagonal values
- Ignore non-diagonal values
- Return stored diagonal values
- Return zero for non-diagonal positions
- Display the full square matrix
- Release dynamic memory when the object is destroyed

5. Class structure

The class structure is:

```
class Diagonal {
private:
    int *A;
    int n;

public:
    Diagonal();
    Diagonal(int n);
    ~Diagonal();

    void Set(int i, int j, int x);
    int Get(int i, int j);
    void Display();
};
```

This class has two main sections:

```
private:
```

and:

```
public:
```

6. Private data members

The private data members are:

```
int *A;  
int n;
```

Meaning of `int *A`

```
int *A;
```

means `A` is a pointer to an integer array.

This array stores only the diagonal values.

Example:

```
A = [5, 8, 9, 12]
```

This represents the full matrix:

```
5 0 0 0  
0 8 0 0  
0 0 9 0  
0 0 0 12
```

Only the diagonal values are stored.

The zeros are not stored.

Meaning of `int n`

```
int n;
```

stores the dimension of the matrix.

If:

```
n = 4;
```

then the matrix is treated as a `4 × 4` matrix.

Even though we store only 4 diagonal values, the visible matrix has:

```
4 × 4 = 16 positions
```

7. Why are `A` and `n` private?

The data members are private so outside code cannot directly change them.

This protects the diagonal matrix rule.

For example, outside code should not directly do this:

```
d.A[2] = 99;
```

Instead, the user should call:

```
d.Set(3, 3, 99);
```

The `Set()` method checks whether the position is diagonal before storing the value.

So private data helps the class protect itself.

The object controls how its data changes.

8. Public methods

The public methods are:

```
Diagonal();  
Diagonal(int n);  
~Diagonal();  
void Set(int i, int j, int x);  
int Get(int i, int j);  
void Display();
```

These are the functions that outside code is allowed to use.

Method	Purpose
<code>Diagonal()</code>	Creates a default matrix.
<code>Diagonal(int n)</code>	Creates a matrix with a user-provided size.
<code>~Diagonal()</code>	Releases dynamic memory.
<code>Set()</code>	Stores a value if the position is diagonal.
<code>Get()</code>	Returns a stored value or zero.
<code>Display()</code>	Prints the full matrix.

9. Default constructor

A default constructor is a constructor that does not take any arguments.

It looks like this:

```
Diagonal() {
    n = 2;
    A = new int[2];
}
```

This constructor runs when we create an object like this:

```
Diagonal d;
```

No size is given.

So the default constructor gives the object a safe default size.

In this lesson, the default size is:

```
2 × 2
```

So internally:

```
n = 2
A has 2 integer spaces
```

The visible matrix is:

```
? 0
0 ?
```

The `?` values are diagonal values that can be set later.

10. Why do we need a default constructor?

The default constructor allows this:

```
Diagonal d;
```

Without a default constructor, this line would not work if the class only had:

```
Diagonal(int n);
```

The default constructor makes sure the object is still valid even when no size is provided.

A valid object should have:

```
A matrix size
A memory array
```

So this code:

```
Diagonal() {
    n = 2;
    A = new int[2];
}
```

creates a small valid diagonal matrix.

11. Important correction about `new int[2]`

This code:


```
A = new int[2];
```

allocates memory for 2 integers.

But it does **not always initialize the values to zero**.

That means the array values may contain garbage values until we set them.

A safer version is:

```
A = new int[2]{};
```

The `{}` initializes the values to zero.

So this:

```
A = new int[2]{};
```

creates:

```
A = [0, 0]
```

This is safer for beginners.

12. Parameterized constructor

A parameterized constructor receives a value.

In this lesson, it receives the matrix size.

```
Diagonal(int n) {  
    this->n = n;  
    A = new int[n];  
}
```

This constructor runs when we create an object like this:

```
Diagonal d(4);
```

This means:

```
Create a diagonal matrix of size 4 × 4.
```

Since it is diagonal, we only need to store 4 values.

So internally:

```
n = 4  
A has 4 integer spaces
```

The full matrix has 16 visible positions, but the array stores only 4 values.

13. Understanding `this->n = n`

The parameterized constructor has this line:

```
this->n = n;
```

There are two different `n` names here.

The first one is:

```
this->n
```

This means the object's own `n` data member.

The second one is:

```
n
```

This means the constructor parameter.

So:

```
this->n = n;
```

means:

Store the constructor parameter into the object's n variable.

Example:

```
Diagonal d(4);
```

The constructor receives:

```
n = 4
```

Then:

```
this->n = n;
```

stores 4 into the object's private `n`.

14. Safer parameterized constructor

The basic version is:

```
Diagonal(int n) {  
    this->n = n;  
    A = new int[n];  
}
```

A safer beginner-friendly version is:

```
Diagonal(int n) {  
    this->n = n;  
    A = new int[n]{};  
}
```

The `{}` initializes all values to zero.

Example:

```
Diagonal d(4);
```

creates:

```
A = [0, 0, 0, 0]
```

Then later we can set values:

```
d.Set(1, 1, 5);  
d.Set(2, 2, 8);  
d.Set(3, 3, 9);  
d.Set(4, 4, 12);
```

Then the array becomes:

```
A = [5, 8, 9, 12]
```

15. Destructor

A destructor is a special function that runs automatically when an object is destroyed.

The destructor is:

```
~Diagonal() {  
    delete[] A;  
}
```

The destructor releases the memory that was created using `new`.

In the constructor, we wrote:

```
A = new int[n];
```

So in the destructor, we must write:

```
delete[] A;
```

16. Why do we need a destructor?

We need a destructor because the class uses dynamic memory.

Dynamic memory is created using:

```
new int[n]
```

The program asks the heap for memory.

When the object is finished, the program should return that memory.

If we do not release the memory, we may create a memory leak.

A memory leak means:

The program asked for memory but never gave it back.

So this rule is important:

```
new[] must be matched with delete[]
```

Correct:

```
A = new int[n];  
delete[] A;
```

Wrong:

```
A = new int[n];  
delete A;
```

Why is `delete A` wrong?

Because `A` points to an array, not one single integer.

For arrays, use:

```
delete[] A;
```

17. Set() method

The Set() method stores a value in the matrix.

Code:

```
void Set(int i, int j, int x) {  
    if (i == j) {  
        A[i - 1] = x;  
    }  
}
```

Meaning:

- `i` is the row number.
- `j` is the column number.
- `x` is the value to store.

The method stores `x` only if:

```
i == j
```

If `i != j`, the method does nothing.

Why?

Because non-diagonal positions must stay zero in a diagonal matrix.

18. Why Set() uses A[i - 1]

Matrix positions are 1-based in Set().

That means positions start from 1:

```
M[1,1]
M[2,2]
M[3,3]
M[4,4]
```

But C++ arrays are 0-based:

```
A[0]
A[1]
A[2]
A[3]
```

So we subtract 1.

Mapping:

Matrix position	Array position
M[1,1]	A[0]
M[2,2]	A[1]
M[3,3]	A[2]
M[4,4]	A[3]

Formula:

```
A[i - 1]
```

This formula is used only when:

```
i == j
```

19. Dry run of Set() for a diagonal position

Call:

```
d.Set(3, 3, 9);
```

Step 1: Identify the values.

```
i = 3  
j = 3  
x = 9
```

Step 2: Check the diagonal condition.

```
i == j  
3 == 3  
true
```

Step 3: Calculate the array index.

```
index = i - 1  
index = 3 - 1  
index = 2
```

Step 4: Store the value.

```
A[2] = 9;
```

So **9** is stored as the third diagonal value.

20. Dry run of **Set()** for a non-diagonal position

Call:

```
d.Set(2, 4, 99);
```

Step 1: Identify the values.

```
i = 2  
j = 4  
x = 99
```

Step 2: Check the diagonal condition.


```
i == j  
2 == 4  
false
```

Step 3: Do nothing.

The value 99 is ignored.

Why?

Because (2,4) is not on the main diagonal.

In a diagonal matrix, (2,4) must be zero.

21. Get() method

The Get() method returns the value at a matrix position.

Code:

```
int Get(int i, int j) {  
    if (i == j) {  
        return A[i - 1];  
    }  
    return 0;  
}
```

Meaning:

- If the position is diagonal, return the stored value.
- If the position is not diagonal, return zero.

So:

```
d.Get(2, 2);
```

returns a stored value.

But:

```
d.Get(1, 4);
```

returns `0`.

22. Why `Get()` returns zero for non-diagonal positions

In a diagonal matrix, every non-diagonal position is a structural zero.

Examples:

```
M[1,2] = 0  
M[1,4] = 0  
M[3,1] = 0  
M[4,2] = 0
```

These zeros are not stored in the array.

The program simply knows they must be zero because of the diagonal matrix rule.

So if:

```
i != j
```

then `Get()` returns:

```
return 0;
```

without checking the array.

23. Dry run of `Get()` for a diagonal position

Assume:

```
A = [5, 8, 9, 12]
```

Call:

```
d.Get(2, 2);
```

Step 1: Check the condition.

```
2 == 2  
true
```

Step 2: Calculate the index.

```
index = i - 1  
index = 2 - 1  
index = 1
```

Step 3: Return the stored value.

```
return A[1];
```

Since:

```
A[1] = 8
```

The answer is:

```
8
```

24. Dry run of `Get()` for a non-diagonal position

Call:

```
d.Get(1, 4);
```

Step 1: Check the condition.

```
1 == 4  
false
```

Step 2: Return zero.

```
return 0;
```

The method does not check the array.

It already knows (1,4) is not on the diagonal.

So the value must be zero.

25. Display() method

The Display() method prints the full visible matrix.

Code:

```
void Display() {  
    for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {  
        for (int j = 0; j < n; j++) {  
            if (i == j) {  
                cout << A[i] << " ";  
            } else {  
                cout << "0 ";  
            }  
        }  
        cout << endl;  
    }  
}
```

The method uses two loops:

- Outer loop: controls rows
- Inner loop: controls columns

For each position:

- If `i == j`, print the stored diagonal value.
 - If `i != j`, print `0`.
-

26. Why `Display()` uses nested loops

The stored array contains only diagonal values.

Example:

```
A = [5, 8, 9, 12]
```

But the displayed matrix must look like a full `4 × 4` matrix:

```
5 0 0 0
0 8 0 0
0 0 9 0
0 0 0 12
```

To print the full matrix, the program must visit every row and every column.

For a `4 × 4` matrix, it prints:

```
4 × 4 = 16 positions
```

That is why `Display()` uses nested loops.

27. Important indexing difference in Lesson 4

This is one of the most important ideas in Lesson 4.

`Set()` and `Get()` use **1-based matrix positions**.

Example:

```
d.Set(1, 1, 5);
d.Set(2, 2, 8);
d.Set(3, 3, 9);
d.Set(4, 4, 12);
```

Here, the matrix positions start at 1.

So the formula is:

A[i - 1]

But `Display()` uses **0-based loops**.

Example:

```
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
```

Here, `i` starts at 0.

So when `i = 0`, the correct array position is:

A[0]

That is why `Display()` uses:

A[i]

not:

A[i - 1]

28. Why `Display()` uses `A[i]` instead of `A[i - 1]`

In `Display()`, the loop starts from 0:

```
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
```

So the values of `i` are:

0, 1, 2, 3

for a `4 × 4` matrix.

These are already valid array indexes:

A[0], A[1], A[2], A[3]

So the display method uses:

A[i]

If we used:

A[i - 1]

then when `i = 0`, we would get:

A[-1]

That is invalid.

So the rule is:

If the loop starts at 1, use A[i - 1].
If the loop starts at 0, use A[i].

29. 1-based vs 0-based summary

Situation	Loop or input starts at	Correct formula
Set(i, j, x)	1	A[i - 1]
Get(i, j)	1	A[i - 1]
Display() in Lesson 4	0	A[i]

This is why formulas must match the indexing style being used.

30. Full Lesson 4 program

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;
```

```

class Diagonal {
private:
    int *A;
    int n;

public:
    Diagonal() {
        n = 2;
        A = new int[2];
    }

    Diagonal(int n) {
        this->n = n;
        A = new int[n];
    }

    ~Diagonal() {
        delete[] A;
    }

    void Set(int i, int j, int x) {
        if (i == j) {
            A[i - 1] = x;
        }
    }

    int Get(int i, int j) {
        if (i == j) {
            return A[i - 1];
        }
        return 0;
    }

    void Display() {
        for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
            for (int j = 0; j < n; j++) {
                if (i == j) {
                    cout << A[i] << " ";
                } else {
                    cout << "0 ";
                }
            }
            cout << endl;
        }
    }
};

int main() {

```



```

    Diagonal d(4);

    d.Set(1, 1, 5);
    d.Set(2, 2, 8);
    d.Set(3, 3, 9);
    d.Set(4, 4, 12);

    d.Display();

    return 0;
}

```

31. Safer beginner-friendly version of the program

This version initializes the dynamic arrays to zero.

```

#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

class Diagonal {
private:
    int *A;
    int n;

public:
    Diagonal() {
        n = 2;
        A = new int[2]{};
    }

    Diagonal(int n) {
        this->n = n;
        A = new int[n]{};
    }

    ~Diagonal() {
        delete[] A;
    }

    void Set(int i, int j, int x) {
        if (i == j) {
            A[i - 1] = x;
        }
    }
}

```

```

int Get(int i, int j) {
    if (i == j) {
        return A[i - 1];
    }
    return 0;
}

void Display() {
    for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
        for (int j = 0; j < n; j++) {
            if (i == j) {
                cout << A[i] << " ";
            } else {
                cout << "0 ";
            }
        }
        cout << endl;
    }
}

};

int main() {
    Diagonal d(4);

    d.Set(1, 1, 5);
    d.Set(2, 2, 8);
    d.Set(3, 3, 9);
    d.Set(4, 4, 12);

    d.Display();

    return 0;
}

```

The safer version uses:

```
new int[n]{};
```

instead of:

```
new int[n]
```

This helps avoid garbage values before the user stores real values.

32. Explanation of the full program

Header file

```
#include <iostream>
```

This is needed because the program uses:

```
cout  
endl
```

Namespace

```
using namespace std;
```

This allows us to write:

```
cout  
endl
```

instead of:

```
std::cout  
std::endl
```

Class name

```
class Diagonal
```

This creates a class named `Diagonal`.

The class represents a diagonal matrix.

Private section

```
private:  
    int *A;  
    int n;
```

This stores:

```
A = dynamic array of diagonal values  
n = matrix dimension
```

Public section

```
public:
```

This contains the functions that outside code can call.

Default constructor

```
Diagonal() {  
    n = 2;  
    A = new int[2];  
}
```

This creates a default `2 × 2` diagonal matrix.

Parameterized constructor

```
Diagonal(int n) {  
    this->n = n;  
    A = new int[n];  
}
```

This creates a diagonal matrix of size `n × n`.

Destructor

```
~Diagonal() {  
    delete[] A;  
}
```

This releases the dynamic array.

`Set()` method

```
void Set(int i, int j, int x)
```

This stores `x` only if `i == j`.

`Get()` method

```
int Get(int i, int j)
```

This returns:

- `A[i - 1]` if `i == j`
- `0` if `i != j`

`Display()` method

```
void Display()
```

This prints the full matrix using:

- Stored diagonal values
- Fake zeros for non-diagonal positions

`main()` function

```
int main() {  
    Diagonal d(4);  
  
    d.Set(1, 1, 5);  
    d.Set(2, 2, 8);  
    d.Set(3, 3, 9);  
    d.Set(4, 4, 12);  
  
    d.Display();  
  
    return 0;  
}
```

This creates a `4 × 4` diagonal matrix, stores four diagonal values, and displays the matrix.

33. Main function trace

The `main()` function starts here:

```
int main() {
```

Then this line runs:

```
Diagonal d(4);
```

This calls the parameterized constructor.

The object becomes:

```
n = 4  
A has 4 spaces
```

If using the safer version:

```
A = new int[4]{};
```

then initially:

```
A = [0, 0, 0, 0]
```

34. Trace of setting values

First call

```
d.Set(1, 1, 5);
```

Check:

```
1 == 1 → true
```

Index:

```
1 - 1 = 0
```

Store:

```
A[0] = 5
```

Array now:

```
[5, 0, 0, 0]
```

Second call

```
d.Set(2, 2, 8);
```

Check:

```
2 == 2 → true
```

Index:

```
2 - 1 = 1
```

Store:

```
A[1] = 8
```

Array now:

```
[5, 8, 0, 0]
```

Third call

```
d.Set(3, 3, 9);
```

Check:

```
3 == 3 → true
```

Index:

```
3 - 1 = 2
```

Store:

```
A[2] = 9
```

Array now:

```
[5, 8, 9, 0]
```

Fourth call

```
d.Set(4, 4, 12);
```

Check:

```
4 == 4 → true
```

Index:

```
4 - 1 = 3
```

Store:

```
A[3] = 12
```

Array now:

```
[5, 8, 9, 12]
```

35. Trace of `Display()`

The display function uses:


```

for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
    for (int j = 0; j < n; j++) {
        if (i == j) {
            cout << A[i] << " ";
        } else {
            cout << "0 ";
        }
    }
    cout << endl;
}

```

For `n = 4`, the loop values are:

```

i = 0, 1, 2, 3
j = 0, 1, 2, 3

```

Stored array:

```

A = [5, 8, 9, 12]

```

Row 1

When `i = 0`:

```

j = 0: i == j, print A[0] = 5
j = 1: i != j, print 0
j = 2: i != j, print 0
j = 3: i != j, print 0

```

Output row:

```

5 0 0 0

```

Row 2

When `i = 1`:

```

j = 0: i != j, print 0
j = 1: i == j, print A[1] = 8

```

```
j = 2: i != j, print 0  
j = 3: i != j, print 0
```

Output row:

```
0 8 0 0
```

Row 3

When `i = 2`:

```
j = 0: i != j, print 0  
j = 1: i != j, print 0  
j = 2: i == j, print A[2] = 9  
j = 3: i != j, print 0
```

Output row:

```
0 0 9 0
```

Row 4

When `i = 3`:

```
j = 0: i != j, print 0  
j = 1: i != j, print 0  
j = 2: i != j, print 0  
j = 3: i == j, print A[3] = 12
```

Output row:

```
0 0 0 12
```

36. Expected output

The expected output is:

```
5 0 0 0
0 8 0 0
0 0 9 0
0 0 0 12
```

This is the full visible matrix.

But the actual stored array is only:

```
A = [5, 8, 9, 12]
```

The zeros are printed by the program.

They are not stored.

37. Stored array vs visible matrix

The stored array is what the computer actually keeps in memory.

```
A = [5, 8, 9, 12]
```

The visible matrix is what the user sees.

```
5 0 0 0
0 8 0 0
0 0 9 0
0 0 0 12
```

The important difference:

```
Stored form: only diagonal values
Visible form: full square matrix
```

This is the main memory-saving idea.

38. Why storage is efficient

A normal `4 × 4` matrix stores every value.

That means:

$4 \times 4 = 16$ values

But a diagonal matrix stores only the diagonal values.

That means:

4 values

For a general $N \times N$ matrix:

Matrix type	Stored values
Normal matrix	N^2
Diagonal matrix	N

So diagonal matrix storage is much smaller.

Example for $N = 1000$:

Matrix type	Stored values
Normal matrix	1,000,000
Diagonal matrix	1,000

That is a big memory saving.

39. Time and space complexity

Constructor complexity

The constructor allocates an array of size N .

```
A = new int[n];
```

So space complexity is:

$O(N)$

From this lesson's simplified view, the constructor time is treated as:

$O(1)$

because it mainly performs assignment and allocation.

`Set()` complexity

The `Set()` method does:

- One condition check
- One index calculation if needed
- One assignment if needed

It does not use loops.

So time complexity is:

$O(1)$

`Get()` complexity

The `Get()` method does:

- One condition check
- One array access if needed
- Or immediately returns zero

It does not use loops.

So time complexity is:

$O(1)$

`Display()` complexity

The `Display()` method uses two nested loops.

For an $N \times N$ matrix, it prints:

N^2 positions

So time complexity is:

$O(N^2)$

Even though storage is $O(N)$, display is still $O(N^2)$ because the full visible matrix has N^2 positions.

40. Complexity table

Operation	Time Complexity	Space Complexity	Reason
Matrix storage	—	$O(N)$	Store only N diagonal values.
Constructor	$O(1)$	$O(N)$	Allocates one array of size N .
Set()	$O(1)$	—	One condition and one index expression.
Get()	$O(1)$	—	One condition and one possible array lookup.
Display()	$O(N^2)$	—	Prints every visible matrix position.

41. Common beginner mistakes

Mistake 1: Using $A[i - 1]$ in 0-based Display()

Wrong:

```
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {  
    cout << A[i - 1];  
}
```

When $i = 0$, this becomes:

$A[-1]$

That is invalid.

Correct:

```
cout << A[i];
```

because `i` already starts at 0.

Mistake 2: Forgetting the destructor

Wrong:

```
~Diagonal() {  
}
```

Correct:

```
~Diagonal() {  
    delete[] A;  
}
```

Because the constructor used:

```
new int[n]
```

Mistake 3: Using `delete` instead of `delete[]`

Wrong:

```
delete A;
```

Correct:

```
delete[] A;
```

Because `A` points to an array.

Mistake 4: Thinking all displayed zeros are stored

The output may look like this:

```
5 0 0 0
0 8 0 0
0 0 9 0
0 0 0 12
```

But the stored array is only:

```
[5, 8, 9, 12]
```

The zeros are printed logically.

They are not stored.

Mistake 5: Trying to store non-diagonal values

Wrong idea:

```
d.Set(1, 3, 99);
```

should store `99` somewhere.

Correct idea:

```
d.Set(1, 3, 99);
```

should do nothing.

Reason:

```
1 != 3
```

So `(1,3)` is not diagonal.

It must stay zero.

Mistake 6: Forgetting that `Set()` and `Get()` use 1-based positions

For `Set()` and `Get()`, this is correct:


```
d.Set(1, 1, 5); // stores in A[0]
```

This mapping is used:

```
M[1,1] → A[0]  
M[2,2] → A[1]  
M[3,3] → A[2]
```

So the formula is:

```
A[i - 1]
```

42. Beginner mental model

Think of the class as a small machine.

Inside the machine:

```
n = matrix size  
A = stored diagonal values
```

Outside the machine, the user can press buttons:

```
Set()  
Get()  
Display()
```

The user does not directly touch the stored array.

The class protects the diagonal matrix rule.

When the user calls:

```
d.Set(i, j, x);
```

The class checks:

```
if (i == j)
```

If true, it stores the value.

If false, it ignores the value.

When the user calls:

```
d.Get(i, j);
```

The class checks:

```
if (i == j)
```

If true, it returns a stored value.

If false, it returns zero.

When the user calls:

```
d.Display();
```

The class prints a full matrix using stored values and fake zeros.

43. Practice example 1

Suppose:

```
Diagonal d(3);
```

Then:

```
d.Set(1, 1, 10);  
d.Set(2, 2, 20);  
d.Set(3, 3, 30);
```

Stored array:

```
A = [10, 20, 30]
```

Visible matrix:

```
10 0 0
0 20 0
0 0 30
```

Questions:

```
d.Get(1, 1)
d.Get(2, 2)
d.Get(3, 1)
d.Get(1, 3)
```

Answers:

Operation	Answer	Reason
d.Get(1, 1)	10	Diagonal position, return <code>A[0]</code> .
d.Get(2, 2)	20	Diagonal position, return <code>A[1]</code> .
d.Get(3, 1)	0	Non-diagonal position.
d.Get(1, 3)	0	Non-diagonal position.

44. Practice example 2

Suppose:

```
Diagonal d(4);
```

Then:

```
d.Set(1, 1, 4);
d.Set(2, 2, 6);
d.Set(3, 3, 8);
d.Set(4, 4, 10);
```

Stored array:

A = [4, 6, 8, 10]

Visible matrix:

```
4 0 0 0
0 6 0 0
0 0 8 0
0 0 0 10
```

Questions and answers:

Operation	Answer	Reason
d.Get(4, 4)	10	Diagonal, return A[3].
d.Get(2, 4)	0	Non-diagonal.
d.Set(3, 3, 99)	Stores 99 at A[2]	Diagonal.
d.Set(1, 4, 77)	Ignored	Non-diagonal.

After:

d.Set(3, 3, 99);

The array becomes:

A = [4, 6, 99, 10]

The visible matrix becomes:

```
4 0 0 0
0 6 0 0
0 0 99 0
0 0 0 10
```

45. Key rules from Lesson 4

Diagonal condition

```
i == j
```

This means the position is on the main diagonal.

Non-diagonal condition

```
i != j
```

This means the position is outside the main diagonal.

Set() rule

```
If i == j, store x in A[i - 1].  
If i != j, do nothing.
```

Get() rule

```
If i == j, return A[i - 1].  
If i != j, return 0.
```

Display() rule

```
Loop through all visible positions.  
Print A[i] when i == j.  
Print 0 when i != j.
```

Memory rule

```
new[] must be matched with delete[]
```

Indexing rule

```
Set/Get use 1-based matrix positions, so use A[i - 1].  
Display uses 0-based loops, so use A[i].
```

46. Lesson 4 final summary

Lesson 4 teaches how to build a complete C++ diagonal matrix program.

The matrix type is still a diagonal matrix.

The rule is still:

```
i == j
```

Only diagonal values are stored.

All non-diagonal values are structural zeros.

The class stores:

```
int *A;  
int n;
```

`A` stores the diagonal values.

`n` stores the matrix dimension.

The class includes:

```
Diagonal();  
Diagonal(int n);  
~Diagonal();  
Set();  
Get();  
Display();
```

The default constructor creates a safe default `2 × 2` matrix.

The parameterized constructor creates a matrix of the requested size.

The destructor releases the dynamic array using:

```
delete[] A;
```

The `Set()` method stores values only when `i == j`.

The `Get()` method returns stored values for diagonal positions and returns `0` for non-diagonal positions.

The `Display()` method prints the full matrix using nested loops.

The most important new indexing idea is:

Set/Get use 1-based positions, so they use `A[i - 1]`.
Display uses 0-based loops, so it uses `A[i]`.

Storage is efficient because a diagonal matrix stores only `N` values instead of `N2` values.

So storage complexity is:

`O(N)`

`Set()` and `Get()` are:

`O(1)`

because they use direct formulas.

`Display()` is:

`O(N2)`

because it prints every visible position in the full matrix.

47. Exit questions

You should be able to answer these before moving to Lesson 5.

1. What is the purpose of Lesson 4?
2. What is a default constructor?
3. What does the default constructor do in this lesson?
4. What is a parameterized constructor?
5. What does `this->n = n` mean?
6. Why do we use `new int[n]`?

7. Why is `new int[n]{}` safer for beginners?
 8. What does the destructor do?
 9. Why do we use `delete[] A` instead of `delete A`?
 10. What does `Set(3, 3, 9)` do?
 11. What does `Set(2, 4, 99)` do?
 12. What does `Get(2, 2)` return if `A[1] = 8`?
 13. Why does `Get(1, 4)` return zero?
 14. Why does `Display()` use nested loops?
 15. Why does `Display()` use `A[i]` instead of `A[i - 1]`?
 16. What is the storage complexity of a diagonal matrix?
 17. What is the time complexity of `Set()`?
 18. What is the time complexity of `Get()`?
 19. What is the time complexity of `Display()`?
 20. What is the main indexing lesson from Lesson 4?
-

48. Short answers to exit questions

1. Lesson 4 teaches a complete C++ diagonal matrix class program.
2. A default constructor creates an object without receiving arguments.
3. It creates a default `2 × 2` diagonal matrix.
4. A parameterized constructor creates an object using a given value, such as matrix size.
5. It stores the constructor parameter `n` into the object's private `n` variable.
6. We use `new int[n]` to create a dynamic array of the correct size.
7. `new int[n]{}` initializes the array values to zero.
8. The destructor releases the dynamic memory.
9. We use `delete[] A` because `A` points to an array.
10. It stores `9` at `A[2]`.
11. It does nothing because `(2,4)` is not diagonal.
12. It returns `8`.
13. Because `(1,4)` is a structural zero.
14. Because it must print every visible matrix position.
15. Because the display loop starts from `0`, so `i` is already a valid array index.
16. Storage complexity is `O(N)`.
17. `Set()` is `O(1)`.
18. `Get()` is `O(1)`.
19. `Display()` is `O(N²)`.
20. The main indexing lesson is: use `A[i - 1]` for 1-based matrix positions, but use `A[i]` for 0-based loops.